

Sign test example

X = length of time in sec between 2 calls to a call center

$$H_0: m = 6.2$$

$$H_1: m < 6.2$$

$$\tilde{H}_1: m > 6.2$$

} we will test against both alternatives

Data: 6, 7, 3, 2, 19, 10, 8, 4, 10, 7

Signs of $X_i - m_0$ $\ominus$ $\oplus$ $\ominus$ $\ominus$ $\oplus$ $\oplus$ $\oplus$ $\ominus$ $\oplus$ $\oplus$

S = # of $\oplus$'s = 6 out of 10 $\sim \text{Binom}(10, \frac{1}{2})$

Significance level $\alpha = 10\%$.

(a) Testing $H_0: m = 6.2$ vs $H_1: m < 6.2$

We reject H_0 in favor of H_1

- if true median looks < 6.2
- if $P(X_i > 6.2) < P(X_i > \text{true median}) = 0.5$
- if number of $\oplus$'s (S) is too small
[as probability of each $\oplus$ is < 0.5]

Critical region $C = \{S \leq c\}$ (S is too small)

Since Binom is discrete, it is not convenient to search for critical region explicitly (there is no c : $P(S \leq c) = \text{exactly } 0.1$)

$$p\text{-value} = P(S \leq \underset{\substack{\downarrow \\ \text{observed}}}{6}) > 0.5 > 0.1 = \alpha \Rightarrow \boxed{\text{accept } H_0}$$

(b) Testing $H_0: m = 6.2$ vs $\tilde{H}_1: m > 6.2$

We reject H_0 in favor of $\tilde{H}_1$

- if true median > 6.2
- so, $P(X_i > 6.2) > P(X_i > \text{true median}) = 0.5$
- so, S is too big $\{S \geq c\} \rightarrow \text{reject}$

$$\begin{aligned} p\text{-value} &= P\{S \geq 6\} = 1 - P(S < 6) = \\ &= 1 - P(S \leq 5) = (\text{Table I}) \\ &= 1 - 0.623 = 0.377 > 0.1 \\ &\quad p\text{-value} > \alpha \end{aligned}$$

$\Rightarrow \boxed{\text{accept } H_0}$